

Does AI actually consume more water than other online tools and platforms?

Posted by u/ChopperSophocles • 0 points • 70 comments

I understand that popular AI tools, like ChatGPT or Midjourney, use a lot of water for the cooling needs of their data centers. But I am not sure if it is exponentially more than other things that use data centers: like uploading TikTok videos, sharing pics on Instagram, playing online games, or asking Reddit. I assume it's more because it generates files rather than just storing them, but how much worse is it actually? What can I read about it?

Comments

u/fhigurethisout • 1 points • 2025-10-20 21:09 UTC

Video streaming is much, much worse.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-07-31 17:35 UTC

[removed]

u/waffleassembly • 1 points • 2025-05-15 20:03 UTC

Don't worry. Quantum computing is right around the corner and quantum processors only need to be kept at 0.01 to 0.1 Kelvin to function

u/NotRandomseer • 1 points • 2025-05-09 05:44 UTC

The water thing is stupid, most water is just fed back into the loop and it's negligible.

The electricity consumption of AI is rather high , especially for training the model (creating it) , but much less so for inference (running the models).

Even if the cost to use it per minute is higher than other options like video streaming though, its negligible as it's not used anywhere near as often. When streaming video , you're streaming video 90 percent of the time , while when you ask a model a question, you spend 90 percent of your time reading the response while the model isn't actually being used. People also use llms a lot less than video streaming.

As a whole other platforms probably consume similar amounts or more. While it does consume a lot of electricity, so does pretty much everything on the internet , people who selectively ignore the electricity consumption of everything except AI have an agenda and are either misinformed or dislike AI for a different reason and are looking for an excuse to hate

u/jghjtrj • 1 points • 2025-05-09 05:23 UTC

Aside: “exponentially more” does not mean “a lot more”

It's specially talking about a pattern of self compounding growth. One thing can be never “exponentially more” than any one other thing.

If that are the case, could I also say “I have sinusoidally more money than you” or “my car is quadratically heavier than yours”? Huh?